TidyTuesday Week 28

Pranay Gundam

Saturday 11th July, 2026

Contents

1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the only weekly newsletter brave enough to yank two completely unrelated economic time series out of a hat and demand that they explain each other. This week's contestants ranged from frozen dinners to Austrian anxiety, and I regret to inform you that some of them actually cooperated. As always, a friendly reminder before we begin: these pairings are random, the correlations are almost certainly spurious, and drawing real conclusions from any of this is like reading tea leaves, except the tea is a discontinued FRED dataset.

We open Monday with the crown jewel of the week: the Producer Price Index for Frozen Specialty Food Manufacturing versus Transportation Carbon Dioxide Emissions from petroleum. Folks, the R-squared came in at a positively scandalous 0.58, with a p-value so small it needs a magnifying glass (that's 1.18e-07, for those of you keeping score at home). Statistically speaking, this is the closest thing to true love our little project has ever witnessed. Am I saying that the price of frozen taquitos secretly governs America's tailpipe emissions? No. Of course not. That would be insane. But I am saying the numbers refuse to let me rule it out, and I will be thinking about this for the rest of my natural life.

Tuesday brought us crashing back to earth with Other Real Estate Loans Owned by Finance Companies against some magnificently obscure loan-size metric. The R-squared was a humble 0.017 and the p-value strolled in at 0.24, which in technical terms means "these two have never met and would not recognize each other at a party." Wednesday was slightly more exciting: Debt Securities Held by the Bottom 50 Percent versus the World Uncertainty Index for Austria squeaked out a statistically significant p-value of 0.011, though with an R-squared of 0.043 it explains roughly four percent of anything. So yes, technically significant, practically a rounding error. Austria's worries and America's bottom-half bond holdings may share a whisper of a relationship, or, more likely, they simply happened to wiggle at the same time. Truly a heartwarming coincidence.

We closed out the week Thursday with the Employment Cost Index for education and health workers versus farm product raw materials inventories, and this pairing achieved a level of mutual indifference I can only describe as majestic: R-squared of 0.0046, p-value of 0.50. That's a coin flip. That's noise wearing a lab coat. And honestly, that's the natural state of this project, an ocean of nothing occasionally interrupted by a frozen-food-fueled emissions fever dream. Same time next week, where we'll once again torture unsuspecting data into confessing things it never did. Nothing here is real, please do not trade on it, and please do not tell my frozen taquitos I love them.

2 Date: 2026-07-08

Series ID: PCU311412311412P

This series is titled Producer Price Index by Industry: Frozen Specialty Food Manufacturing: Primary Products and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 1982=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1982-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-05-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: EMISSCO2TOTVTCPEA

This series is titled Transportation Carbon Dioxide Emissions, Petroleum for United States (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Million Metric Tons CO2 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1980-01-01 and the observation end date is 2017-01-01.The popularity of this series is 3.

2.1 Regression Tables and Plots

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EMISSCO2TOTVTCPEA	**R-squared:**	0.578
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.565
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	45.15
Date:	Wed, 08 Jul 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	1.18e-07
Time:	14:38:29	**Log-Likelihood:**	-215.74
No. Observations:	35	**AIC:**	435.5
Df Residuals:	33	**BIC:**	438.6
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	698.8159	150.774	4.635	0.000	392.063	1005.568
value_fred_PCU311412311412P	7.0696	1.052	6.720	0.000	4.929	9.210

Omnibus:	4.673	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.183
Prob(Omnibus):	0.097	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	4.246
Skew:	0.788	**Prob(JB):**	0.120
Kurtosis:	2.346	**Cond. No.**	1.08e+03

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
[2] The condition number is large, 1.08e+03. This might indicate that there are
strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

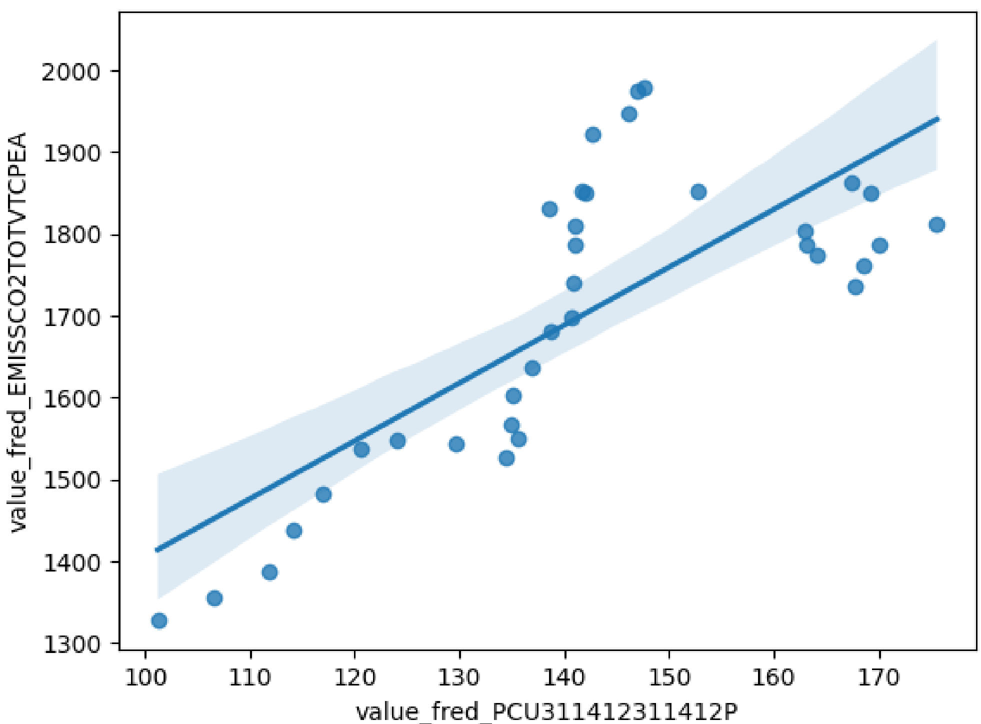

Figure 1: Regression Plot for 2026-07-08

3 Date: 2026-07-09

Series ID: DTROOXDFBANA
This series is titled Other Real Estate Loans Owned by Finance Companies, Flow and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars, Annual Rate and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1970-07-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: EAROTNQ
This series is titled Percent of Value of Loans Prime Based by Average Loan Size ($ thousands), Other, All Commercial Banks (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, 2nd Month's 1st Full Week. The units are Thousands of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1997-04-01 and the observation end date is 2017-04-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Regression Tables and Plots

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EAROTNQ	**R-squared:**	0.017
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.005
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	1.385
Date:	Thu, 09 Jul 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.243
Time:	14:22:39	**Log-Likelihood:**	-600.92
No. Observations:	81	**AIC:**	1206.
Df Residuals:	79	**BIC:**	1211.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	964.6184	45.956	20.990	0.000	873.146	1056.091
value_fred_DTROOXDFBANA	-0.0030	0.003	-1.177	0.243	-0.008	0.002

Omnibus:	1.661	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.331
Prob(Omnibus):	0.436	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	1.307
Skew:	-0.099	**Prob(JB):**	0.520
Kurtosis:	2.410	**Cond. No.**	1.80e+04

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
[2] The condition number is large, 1.8e+04. This might indicate that there are
strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

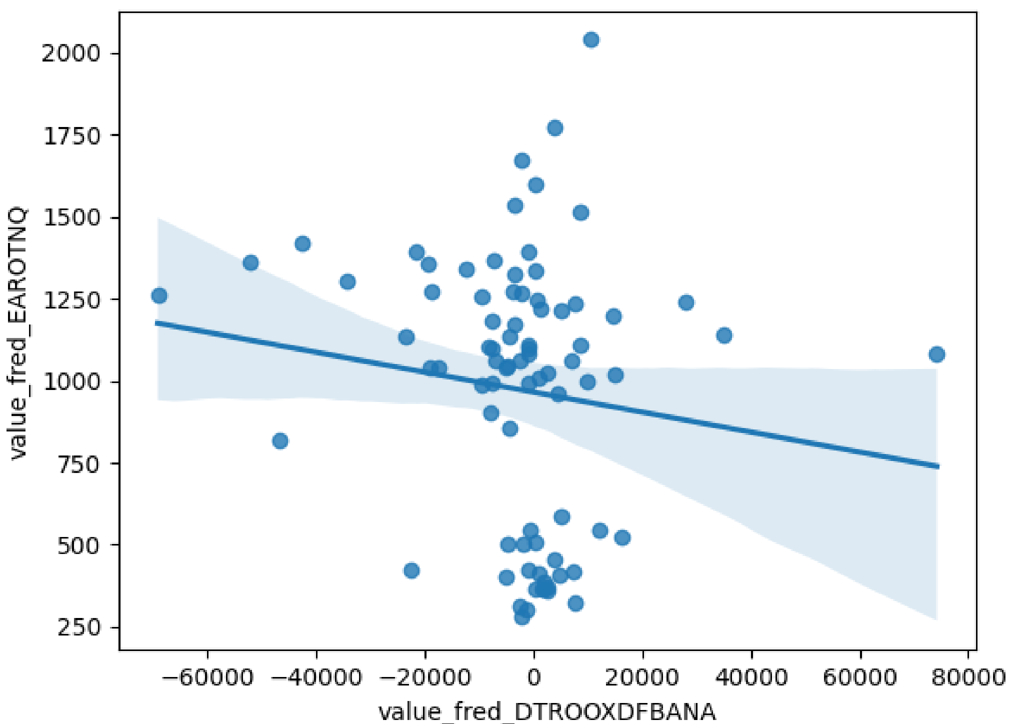

Figure 2: Regression Plot for 2026-07-09

4 Date: 2026-07-10

Series ID: WFRBLB50089

This series is titled Debt Securities Held by the Bottom 50% (1st to 50th Wealth Percentiles) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1989-07-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01.The popularity of this series is 2.

Series ID: WUIAUT

This series is titled World Uncertainty Index for Austria and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1963-10-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01.The popularity of this series is 4.

4.1 Regression Tables and Plots

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_WUIAUT	**R-squared:**	0.043
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.037
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	6.562
Date:	Fri, 10 Jul 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.0114
Time:	13:49:59	**Log-Likelihood:**	43.795
No. Observations:	147	**AIC:**	-83.59
Df Residuals:	145	**BIC:**	-77.61
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	0.0462	0.050	0.915	0.361	-0.054	0.146
value_fred_WFRBLB50089	4.969e-06	1.94e-06	2.562	0.011	1.14e-06	8.8e-06

Omnibus:	62.192	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.751
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	182.832
Skew:	1.688	**Prob(JB):**	1.99e-40
Kurtosis:	7.296	**Cond. No.**	8.79e+04

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
[2] The condition number is large, 8.79e+04. This might indicate that there are
strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

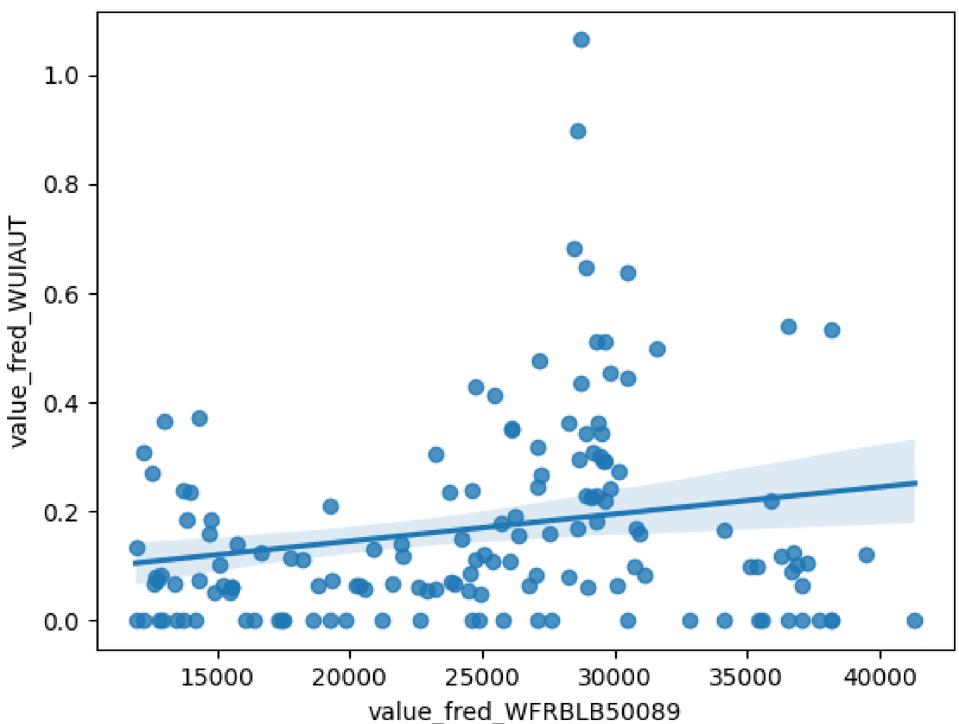

Figure 3: Regression Plot for 2026-07-10

5 Date: 2026-07-11

Series ID: CIS2026000000000I

This series is titled Employment Cost Index: Wages and salaries for Private industry workers in Education and health services and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index Dec 2005=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2001-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: T4245MM157NCEN

This series is titled Merchant Wholesalers, Except Manufacturers' Sales Branches and Offices: Nondurable Goods: Farm Product Raw Materials Inventories and has a frequency of Monthly, End of Month. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1992-02-01 and the observation end date is 2026-05-01.The popularity of this series is 2.

5.1 Regression Tables and Plots

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_T4245MM157NCEN	**R-squared:**	0.005
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.006
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.4526
Date:	Sat, 11 Jul 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.503
Time:	12:45:55	**Log-Likelihood:**	-466.08
No. Observations:	101	**AIC:**	936.2
Df Residuals:	99	**BIC:**	941.4
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-0.7397	12.906	-0.057	0.954	-26.348	24.869
value_fred_CIS2026000000000I	0.0692	0.103	0.673	0.503	-0.135	0.273

Omnibus:	20.134	**Durbin-Watson:**	2.400
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	25.776
Skew:	1.229	**Prob(JB):**	2.53e-06
Kurtosis:	3.281	**Cond. No.**	660.

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

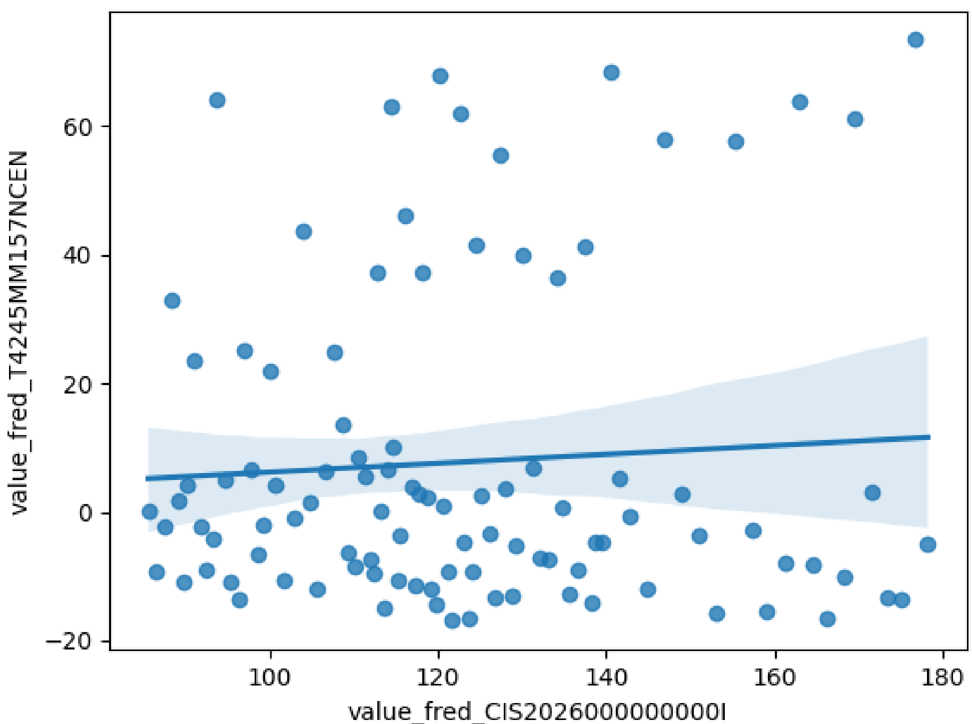

Figure 4: Regression Plot for 2026-07-11